

(V13) Esports Team

Description and Eligibility

This contest will test a team's ability to research and create strategies to effectively compete in a virtual esports competition. Teams will submit a research paper on the provided esports topic, compete in an esports tournament, and create a presentation highlighting strategies used and the lessons learned. This national event will be submitted and judged virtually. Awards will be presented at the National Leadership Conference. Any middle level, secondary or postsecondary contestant may enter this event. A team will consist of 2-4 contestants, depending on the division. There are no restrictions on the number of entries per chapter or per state. **Teams who do not submit an entry following the topic listed below or do not follow the Copyright and/or Fair Use Guidelines will be disqualified.**

Topic

Esports has become a worldwide phenomenon, with markets flourishing across North America, Europe, Asia, Latin America, and Africa. In a research paper of no more than three pages (double-spaced), examine how esports has developed globally and the international business and career opportunities that have emerged as a result.

Research Focus (choose or integrate multiple angles):

1. **International Market Trends & Key Regions**
 - Compare how esports has scaled in at least two different global regions (e.g. North America vs. East Asia, or Europe vs. Latin America).
 - Include recent data on market size, audience growth, tournament revenue, or regional investments.
2. **Global Business Careers & Cross-Sector Roles**
 - Identify at least three business-related careers or roles that operate across borders (examples: international event coordination, global sponsorship management, esports consultancy, broadcast localization, player management/agency across regions).
 - Discuss cross-cultural and international aspects of these roles.
3. **Skills, Certifications & Cultural Competency**
 - Explore what skills, qualifications, language proficiencies, or intercultural competencies are valuable for working in the global esports business environment.
4. **International Collaboration & BPA Engagement**
 - Suggest ways that BPA members—through virtual collaboration, team pitches, or academic exchanges—could engage with global esports projects or international student teams.
 - Mention how BPA experiences (e.g. virtual teamwork, project management, or competitions) build relevant capabilities for international esports business engagement.

Competition Notes

- Contest Registration
 - Advisors register members for the event using the Membership Registration System, accessible at <https://register.bpa.org>.
 - Click on the "Conferences" tab and then select the "2026 National Virtual Events".
 - There will be a \$50 fee for each team entry (*invoiced during event registration*).
 - Event registration can be purchased with your original invoice or with a new invoice after member registration.
 - The registration deadline is no later than 11:59 p.m. Eastern Time, on December 1, 2025.
 - Contestants participating in the competition must be registered for the event prior to the submission deadline to be eligible.
 - Only the team captain should complete the submission.
- All teams will play Rocket League and must have a minimum of three (3) contestants. Teams may have a maximum of four contestants; not all contestants of the team are required to play during the game play round.

Technical Pre-submit Specifications

What to Submit at https://upload.bpa.org	Saved File Name(s)	Deadline
Clickable URL to Project Files, Works Cited and BPA Release Form(s) in one combined PDF file.	V13-TeamID.pdf	January 15, 2026, 11:59 p.m. Eastern Time

Contest Competencies

- Analyze and troubleshoot strategies for esports related scenarios
- Analyze game characteristics and game play data to create a strategic plan
- Compare and contrast the similarities of how esports technology and social media have affected today's culture
- Create a visualization to demonstrate strategy and problem-solving techniques
- Create goals (short and long-term) for individuals and teams during esports competition
- Create strategies for efficient game play during esports tournament
- Define and describe how a player's personality affects team strategy
- Demonstrate effective technical reading and writing skills
- Demonstrate effective verbal and non-verbal communication skills
- Demonstrate healthy gaming concepts and strategies in both local and virtual environments
- Identify patterns and various play styles of pro players and recognize how application of these skills and patterns improves game play
- Implement effective time-management skills in relation to esports, academics, and personal life
- Research game mechanics and other parts (visuals, sound, genre) of the game development process
- Research the various roles and skills necessary to support the esports ecosystem and industry
- Summarize the basic concepts of intellectual property laws in esports, including copyright, trademarks, DMCA, patents, and the consequences of violating copyright laws
- Summarize the legal and ethical responsibilities in relation to esports, gaming, and emerging technology fields

Contest Specifications for this Event

- The research paper must *not* exceed three (3) pages single-sided (excluding the Title Page, Table of Contents, and Works Cited). The report must follow the Report format in the *Style & Reference Manual*.
- Any report submitted beyond the maximum number of pages will be *disqualified*.
- Submit the URL to the final Project Files including the research paper, the Works Cited and BPA Release Form(s) in a combined PDF file to <https://upload.bpa.org> no later than 11:59 p.m. Eastern Time, on January 15, 2026. **No changes can be made to the project after the date of submission.**
- Advisors of qualifying teams will be contacted to reserve a time for a videoconference presentation before a panel of judges. The dates and times for presentation reservations will be announced via email notification. Teams will be assigned to sections prior to the preliminary presentation.
- Length of presentation portion: no more than three (3) minutes for setup, no more than ten (10) minutes for the presentation, and no more than five (5) minutes for judges' questions.
- The top teams with the highest cumulative technical and presentation scores will be invited to attend the National Leadership Conference to be recognized for their outstanding efforts and to participate in the National Showcase.

Common Specifications for all BPA Judged Events

- Team ID is required for all submissions. Materials from non-registered members and/or those missing team ID cannot be accepted.
- The team is responsible for securing a BPA Release Form(s) from any person, including themselves, whose image or work is used in the project.
- The team is responsible for citing all sources, including themselves, on the Works Cited page for any work used on the project. It is the policy of Business Professionals of America to comply with copyright law. The *Style & Reference Manual* contains guidelines for Copyright and/or Fair Use. Contestants will be disqualified for violations of the guidelines.
- Materials must follow the organization's BPA Graphic Standards and make proper use of the BPA logo and/or organization's name. Refer to the BPA Graphic Standards in the *Style & Reference Manual*.
- Judges' comments will be returned digitally through the online judging system at the national level. Materials submitted for technical judging will *not* be returned and will *not* be available at NLC.

This event is sponsored by:



(V13) Esports Team
Technical Scoring Rubric

Required Elements (If any question results in a NO, please assign a score of 0)				
Team followed the topic.				☐ Y ☐ N
Team followed Copyright and/or Fair Use Guidelines.				☐ Y ☐ N
Research Paper did not exceed three (3) pages single-sided (excluding the Title page, Table of Contents and Works Cited).				☐ Y ☐ N
If answered no to any question, please stop scoring and provide a brief reason for the <i>disqualification</i> :				
Submission and Formatting (All points or none are awarded by the technical judge)				
Team submitted one (1) combined PDF file containing the Research Paper, Works Cited formatted according to the <i>Style & Reference Manual</i> and BPA Release Form(s).				/10
Evaluation Criteria	Below Expectations 0-9 points	Meets Expectations 10-15 points	Above Expectations 15-20 points	Points Awarded
Introduction/Summary	Lacks clarity or fails to present key points.	Provides a clear and logical overview with supporting evidence.	Delivers a compelling and well-supported summary that enhances understanding.	/20
Comprehension of Topic	Shows limited understanding or misinterprets key concepts.	Demonstrates solid understanding of the topic.	Shows deep insight and mastery of the subject matter.	/20
Organization & Expansion of Ideas	Ideas are disorganized or lack development.	Ideas are logically structured and supported with evidence.	Ideas are well-developed, insightful, and supported with strong analysis.	/20
Creativity	Lacks originality or relies on limited sources.	Demonstrates creativity with diverse and relevant resources.	Presents a unique and innovative perspective with rich, varied sources.	/20
Writing Accuracy	Frequent grammar or spelling errors.	Contains some grammar or spelling errors.	Contains very few or no grammar or spelling errors.	/20
TOTAL TECHNICAL POINTS				/110

(V13) Esports Team
Presentation Scoring Rubric

Required Elements (If any question results in a NO, please assign a score of 0)				
Team followed the topic.			☐ Y ☐ N	
Team followed Copyright and/or Fair Use Guidelines.			☐ Y ☐ N	
If answered no to either question, please stop scoring and provide a brief reason for the <i>disqualification</i> :				
Evaluation Criteria	Below Expectations 0-9 points	Meets Expectations 10-15 points	Above Expectations 16-20 points	Points Awarded
Opening & Summary	The introduction is unclear or missing, and the summary lacks relevance or completeness.	The introduction sets the stage appropriately, and the summary covers the main points with adequate clarity.	The introduction is engaging and well-structured, and the summary provides a clear, insightful wrap-up that reinforces key findings.	/20
Content of Presentation	Content is unclear, lacks relevance or depth.	Content is clear, relevant, and adequately developed.	Content is insightful, well-developed, and strongly supports the presentation goals.	/20
Presentation Effectiveness	Delivery is distracting or lacks flow and engagement.	Delivery is smooth with good voice projection, transitions, and presence.	Delivery is polished, engaging, and enhances the impact of the presentation.	/20
Judges Questions	Responses lack depth and fail to demonstrate a comprehensive understanding of the topic.	Some responses lack detail or clarity. The understanding of the topic is partially demonstrated.	Responses are detailed, insightful, and effectively address the judges' questions.	/20
Team Members	At least two original team members were present during the presentation.			/5
Timing	Set-up lasted no longer than three (3) minutes, and the presentation lasted no more than ten (10) minutes.			/10
TOTAL PRESENTATION POINTS				/95

Props and/or additional items shall not be used as a basis for scoring.

PRESENTATION WILL BE STOPPED AT 10 MINUTES